

WEEK 5 • TNF FILM AUDIT

BUCCANEERS @ COWBOYS: THE 2 PREGAME ADJUSTMENTS

A schematic breakdown of the ground game and pass-protection battles behind Thursday night in Arlington.

ADJUSTMENT 01 • THE GROUND GAME

4.4 YPC

TAMPA BAY'S RUSHING AVERAGE

Dallas allows 4.8 a carry. Tampa Bay's defense allows just 3.2.

● DAL OFFENSE: 3.8 YPC • TB DEFENSE: 3.2

ADJUSTMENT 02 • PRESSURE POINTS

16 & 4

TB SACKS ALLOWED & DAL SACKS

Tampa Bay has taken 16 sacks, the most in the NFL. Dallas has 4.

● DAL'S 2 SACKS VS HOU WERE ITS FIRST SINCE WEEK 1

THE TACTICAL IMPERATIVE

Protection and the run game set the script Thursday night.

A rookie quarterback behind the league's most-sacked line meets a Cowboys rush that has barely arrived. Dallas's front, not its offense, may be the swing.

● 7-PAGE SLIDE DECK

THE GROUND GAME EDGE

THE GROUND GAME EDGE: TAMPA BAY VS. DAL'S FRONT

Tampa Bay's rushing average sits above what Dallas has allowed so far this season.

YARDS PER CARRY: TAMPA BAY OFFENSE VS. DALLAS DEFENSE ALLOWED

BUCCANEERS RUSH OFFENSE, 2026



97 CARRIES, 424 YARDS, 3 TD • NFL.COM

COWBOYS RUSH DEFENSE, YARDS ALLOWED PER CARRY



126 CARRIES, 601 YARDS ALLOWED, 4 TD • NFL.COM

WHAT THE NUMBERS SAY

The Bucs run well, but Dallas's defense bleeds yards

THE EDGE

Dallas has faced 126 carries, the 4th most in the NFL, and allowed 33 rushing first downs.

Bucky Irving has 241 yards on 56 carries (4.3) and 1 TD, per NFL.com.

THE COUNTERPOINT

Tampa Bay's defense allows only 3.2 yards a carry and 1 rushing TD.

Dallas runs for 3.8 a carry, but has 6 rushing TDs.

WATCH: TAMPA BAY NEEDS 4.4+ YARDS PER CARRY TO MATCH ITS SEASON RATE

THE OFFENSIVE MANDATE:

Lean on Irving early. Rookie QB Jalon Daniels makes his second NFL start.

Tampa Bay has 3 passing TDs and 5 INTs on 126 attempts. Run success keeps the chains short.

THE TACTICAL BLUEPRINT

THE BLUEPRINT: RUN TO PROTECT THE ROOKIE

How Tampa Bay turns a ground-game edge into a manageable script for a first-year starter.

STEP 1 • FRONT-LOAD THE RUN

Irving gets the early-down carries

Irving has 241 yards and a touchdown on 56 carries. Dallas gives up 4.8 a carry, 601 yards on 126 attempts.

STEP 2 • USE THE QB'S LEGS

Daniels adds a rushing dimension

In his first NFL start, Daniels threw for 148 yards and a TD and ran for 55 yards in a 17-14 loss to Green Bay.

STEP 3 • WIN THIRD DOWN

Short yardage keeps the offense on the field

Tampa Bay has converted 19 of 55 third downs, 34.5%. Dallas's defense has allowed 23 of 44.

THE NUMBERS BEHIND THE PLAN

241

IRVING RUSH YDS

On 56 carries, 1 TD this season

34.5%

TB THIRD-DOWN RATE

19-for-55 through Week 4

55

DANIELS RUSH YDS

In his Week 4 first start

LIVE IN-GAME TRIGGER: TRACK TAMPA BAY'S FIRST-DOWN CALLS, RUN OR PASS?

THE PROTECTION PROBLEM

PRESSURE POINTS: TAMPA'S LINE VS. DAL'S RUSH

Tampa Bay has taken the most sacks in the NFL. Dallas has produced few.

SACKS THROUGH WEEK 4: TB TAKEN VS. DAL ALLOWED

TAMPA BAY OFFENSE: SACKS TAKEN



16 SACKS, 74 YARDS LOST ON 126 ATTEMPTS • NFL.COM

DALLAS OFFENSE: SACKS TAKEN



6 SACKS, 33 YARDS LOST ON 150 ATTEMPTS • NFL.COM

THE PRESSURE STORY

Dallas needs its pass rush to show up

DALLAS'S PASS RUSH

The Cowboys have 4 team sacks, 28th in the NFL, per NFL.com.

Their 2 sacks vs. Houston were their first since Week 1.

TAMPA BAY'S LINE

The Bucs' last drive vs. Green Bay stalled on protection issues, per the team site.

Daniels' first start came behind a line with 16 sacks allowed.

WATCH: DALLAS NEEDS 4 SACKS TO MATCH TAMPA BAY'S 4.0-PER-GAME ALLOWED RATE

THE DEFENSIVE MANDATE:

Dallas has no interceptions. Pressure on a rookie is the clearest path to the first one.

Tampa Bay has 5 INTs thrown on 126 attempts; Dallas has 0 defensive INTs, 32nd in the NFL.

THE PASS-RUSH BLUEPRINT

THE BLUEPRINT: WIN THE PASS-RUSH WAR

Three things to watch as Dallas tries to speed up a rookie and Tampa Bay tries to keep him upright.

STEP 1 • CHECK THE OFFICIAL REPORTS

Both teams carry injury questions

Tampa Bay says S Antoine Winfield Jr. is out (rib). DAL G Tyler Smith was limited Monday (estimated) after opening his practice window.

STEP 2 • QUICK THROWS VS. PRESSURE

Fast, short throws blunt a slow rush

Dallas has 4 sacks; Tampa Bay has taken 16. Quick game gives Daniels the ball out before the pocket collapses.

STEP 3 • THE LAMB FACTOR

Dallas's passing game feeds CeeDee Lamb

Lamb leads the NFL in catches (37), targets (46) and yards (498), per the Cowboys. Pressure keeps the ball from him.

THE NUMBERS BEHIND THE PLAN

16

TB SACKS TAKEN

Most in the NFL through Week 4

4

DAL SACKS

28th in the NFL, 0 INTs

498

LAMB REC YARDS

37 catches, led the NFL

LIVE IN-GAME TRIGGER: TRACK SACKS AND PRESSURES QUARTER BY QUARTER

THE VALIDATION SCORECARD

HOW TO SCORE THIS REPORT LIVE ON TNF

Track these 3 benchmarks during the broadcast to see who is winning the trenches.

METRIC 01 • PROTECTION

Sacks of each quarterback

Benchmarks: Dallas 4+ sacks (TB allows 4.0 a game). TB 2 or fewer allowed (DAL allows 1.5 a game).

IF IT HOLDS: THE PASS RUSH IS WINNING

METRIC 02 • THE GROUND GAME

Yards per carry vs. season rates

Benchmarks: TB 4.4 or better (DAL allows 4.8); DAL 3.8 or better (TB allows 3.2).

IF IT HOLDS: THE RUN GAME BEATS THE FRONT

METRIC 03 • THIRD DOWN

Third-down conversions

Benchmarks: DAL 5-for-10 (51% season); TB 4-for-12 (33%, 34.5% season).

IF IT HOLDS: DRIVES ARE STAYING ALIVE

SAVE THIS CAROUSEL FOR KICKOFF

Track these 3 benchmarks during the Prime Video broadcast.

We will post our halftime read on X and LinkedIn.



AI-POWERED SPORTS INTELLIGENCE

REAL SCHEME. REAL DATA. ZERO HOT TAKES.

We replace narrative noise with schematic charting and film verification.

PILLAR 01

LIVE TACTICAL CHARTING

Real-time tracking of box counts, coverage shells, and pressure rates.

PILLAR 02

SECOND-HALF ADJUSTMENTS

Coordinator adjustments modeled during the halftime window.

PILLAR 03

ACCOUNTABLE FILM AUDITS

Every pregame projection is checked against the game film afterward.

JOIN THE DISCUSSION

Does Dallas get home on a rookie QB, or does Tampa Bay run its way to a first win?

Drop your score prediction and tell us which adjustment decides the game.

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